Step Two of Nine: Where Getting Mom's Finances Organized Fits

The nine steps of the Medicaid Planning Roadmap when you're planning ahead, with yours marked.

When you start thinking about how a parent's care might be paid for someday, it's hard to tell which part comes first. There's an order to it, and you're near the beginning.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, and who is involved after this step.

Phase 1 · Assess

Understand where you are today.

1 **Understand** Care Needs → Levels of Care & Costs → Care Plan
You finish with: Future Care Planning Assessment

2 **Organize** Income & Assets → Ownership & Expenses → Financial File
You finish with: Family Financial Inventory

You are here. This step is about getting Mom's financial information into one place, with her, while nothing is pressing: her income and assets, how things are owned and what goes out each month, and the file that holds the paperwork. You finish it with an organized picture and the documents easy to find, ready for your Medicaid planner to review.

3 **Assess** Care & Nonfinancial Eligibility → Income & Assets → Barriers & Readiness
You finish with: Medicaid Readiness Assessment

Phase 2 · Plan

Develop and implement your strategy.

4 **Plan** Barriers & Issues → Priorities & Professional Team → Written Plan
You finish with: Advance Medicaid Planning Roadmap

5 **Legal** Authority & Documents → Property, Trusts & Transfers → Attorney Review
You finish with: Legal Planning Review

6 **Financial** Costs & Runway → Asset Treatment & Tools → Strategy & Documentation
You finish with: Long-Term Care Funding Plan

Phase 3 · Secure

Secure benefits, protect assets, and maintain eligibility.

7 **Apply** Prepare → Submit → Manage
You finish with: Medicaid Application-Ready File

8 **Protect** What May Be Protected → What May Remain Exposed → What Needs Ongoing Attention
You finish with: Asset Protection Assessment

9 **Maintain** Ongoing Requirements → Changes & Renewals → Maintenance System
You finish with: Medicaid Monitoring & Maintenance System

What this step produces

A Family Financial Inventory: an organized record of what Mom owns, receives, owes and spends, with a note of where each document is kept. It is the family's own information, put in order. It isn't a finding about eligibility, and it isn't a plan.

What happens next

After the family's part, the inventory is ready for your Medicaid planner to review: the income, assets, property, insurance, expenses and debts; the ownership, titling and beneficiary information, with a note of what is missing or needs a further look; and whether the file is complete and current, and the family knows where it is kept and who has access. Step three, Assess, closes the first phase and starts from this picture. The second phase begins with the step called Plan.

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: listing, gathering, writing down.
- Mom: it's her information. She decides what is shared, and with whom.
- Her bank, insurers and plan offices: what their own records show, when she asks them.
- Your Medicaid planner: reviews the inventory and the file. The role is education, organization, planning support and coordination across the nine steps.
- An elder law attorney: legal advice and legal documents.
- Licensed insurance and financial professionals: insurance and investment products.
- An applications specialist: preparing an application, if the family reaches that step.

For the roles your family doesn't have yet, the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau notes that many professionals must be licensed or registered by a government agency, and suggests checking credentials with that agency. A local Area Agency on Aging, found through the Eldercare Locator, may also be able to point you to legal aid and other providers in your region. [1] [2]

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. Families move through the steps at different speeds, and when you're planning ahead this one can go at Mom's pace. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits and who is involved after it. The planning interview is a way to begin: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner or to any conversation about paying for care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own. The note on checking a professional's credentials is the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's, and the pointer to the Eldercare Locator follows AARP.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Managing someone else's money: Help for agents under a power of attorney
2. AARP, Legal Checklist for Caregivers With Aging Parents